ECCS 3351: Embedded Realtime Applications
Reading and Reflection 5: Cognitive Bias and Radical Honesty Challenge
Due online by 8 AM Monday 10/19/2026
[5 pts]

AI Use for this Assignment

Prohibited	Use of AI is prohibited on this assignment.

Watch

"The Most Common Cognitive Bias" Veritasium
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vKA4w2O61Xo

Reflect

Write, in the assignment box in Canvas, your honest answers to the following prompts:

- What are times you've struggled to overcome cognitive bias?
- How can developing honesty help you to overcome cognitive bias?
- Why does it matter?

Watch

"Turbo Encabulator" Dave Rondot
https://youtu.be/Ac7G7xOG2Ag?si=oigbU1DcxiFW13jk

Reflect

Write, in the assignment box in Canvas, your honest answers to the following prompts:

- While this is clearly a satire piece, there are relevant examples of dishonesty in this presentation. What are they?
- Reflecting on this video – what does it tell you about honesty in engineering practice?

Radical Honesty Challenge[1]

For twelve hours, in which you are awake and interacting with others, you must (to the best of your ability) be completely honest. You can refuse to answer questions, but you must not lie, obfuscate, exaggerate, understate, or engage in strategic speech.

Reflect

Write, in the assignment box in Canvas, your honest answers to the following prompts:

- How hard was this challenge for you?
- What did you learn about yourself from this challenge?
- What was hardest about this challenge for you?
- Do you think radical honesty was a net positive or net negative?

[1] From Jessica Flanigan, University of Richmond, by way of J. Brennan, "Anarchist Calisthenics, Radical Honesty, and Creating Social Norms to Cultivate Justice," in "Improving Character: Moral Virtues, Strategies, and Questions." ed. R. Hartman, p. 219.

Rubric

This reflection is not graded according to whether you agree a particular position or reach a particular conclusion. It is graded according to whether you engage specifically and faithfully with the materials/experience.

Requirement	**Value**
Engagement with the materials	1 pt
Accurately represents the content	1 pt
Clearly distinguishes personal feelings and opinions	1 pt
Candid self-reflection	1 pt
Articulates/practices honesty	1 pt